LESSON 2: EIGHTH NOTES

An eighth note has a value of 1/2 of a beat. Here's a few other ways to say that same thing:

Eighth notes occur at a speed of two-per-beat.

Eighth notes are played twice as fast as quarter notes.

Two eighth notes take up the same space as one quarter note.

A "standard measure" of four beats can contain eight eighth notes.

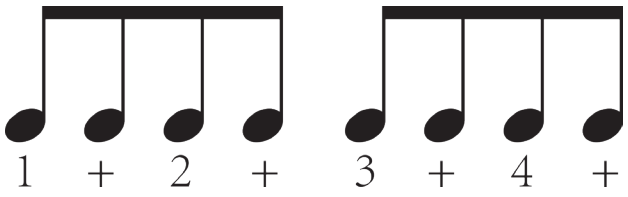
A solitary eighth note in isolation will appear with a small "flag" draping off the top of its stem. When multiple eighth notes are seen together, that flag becomes a straight beam instead.

	Value	*Symbol*	*Counts*
Quarter Note	1 beat	♩	1 2 3 4
Eighth Note	1/2 beat (two notes per beat)	♪	1 + 2 + 3 + 4 +

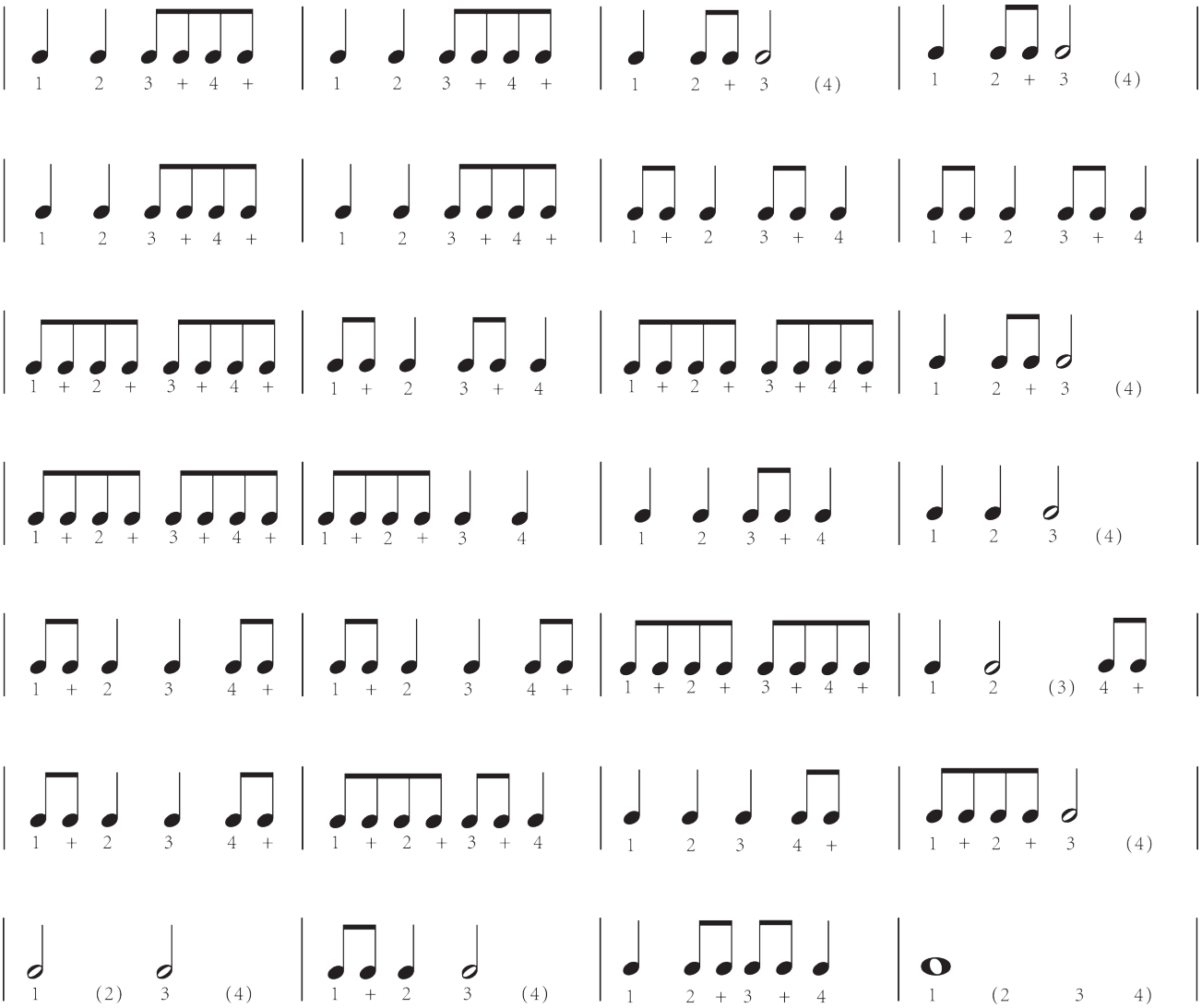
Counting Eighth Notes

Do not count all the way up to the number eight. Instead, count to the number four, but after each number say the word "*and*".

"one and two and three and four and"



Notice how the word *"and"* is represented by a "+" sign.

Exercise (Video #2.1)

Tap your foot on every single beat (one, two, three, four). Say every count out loud while strumming any chord using only downstrokes. Counts that aren't strummed (in parentheses) should be spoken softly.